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Sheremetyevo customs officers prevent a major smuggling attempt involving silver jewellery

Customs officers at Sheremetyevo Airport have thwarted an attempt to smuggle more than 10,000 pieces of silver jewellery. A 50-year-old Armenian citizen arriving from China tried to carry the goods in three suitcases, which were to be loaded onto a flight from Moscow to Yerevan.

Using modern X-ray screening methods, customs officers detected anomalies in the man's luggage, prompting an inspection. They found 273 packages of jewellery containing a total of 10,474 items. The man said he planned to sell the goods in Yerevan.

An expert examination confirmed that the jewellery was made of 925-grade silver alloy and was worth 2 million rubles.

A criminal case has been opened in connection with the smuggling of strategically important goods under Part 1 of Article 226.1 of the Criminal Code of the Russian Federation. The article provides for a penalty of up to seven years' imprisonment and a fine of up to 1 million rubles.

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